

Mining Strategy

On the Road: China trip feedback -> Better...

Equities

Global

Basic Materials

What was the takeaway from our latest China trip? Better.

Our latest China trip in the week of 11th May featured meetings with >25 contacts across industry, government and experts, across two days in Beijing and 2½ days in Shanghai. The one-liner from the trip was incrementally better / bullish vs our last trip in Nov-25. We came away from the tour incrementally positive aluminium & copper 6-12mths forward, our positive lithium price views reinforced, and perhaps a little more sanguine steel and iron ore. We summarise key debates below and read through for key commodities / industries.

Key Themes

- **The one-liner:** was it better / same / worse sequentially (vs last trip in November)? **Better.**
- **Sentiment** appeared sequentially better, with house prices in parts of some Tier 1 cities tracking a little better, attitudes toward second hand property purchases and residential rental incomes improving (despite inventory months still above mid-cycle), the share market at/near record highs, deflation moderating / very muted inflation emerging (PPI +2.8% y/y in Apr albeit energy related), corporate profits +15-20% Mar-Q, and exports strengthening. **Balance of risks** is seen if exports slow, then government can step in with consumer oriented stimulus.
- **Exports:** The positive export story was noteworthy, with contacts reflecting increased export orders partly reflecting lower energy costs in China, and partly reflecting ongoing cost / quality improvements.
- **Government policy** and stimulus has been relatively muted, which is being interpreted as government being comfortable with the broader economy and pace of growth relative to 4.5-5% GDP targets.
- **The 15th Five Year Plan** features a significant focus on grid spend, where announced 15FYP target spend by State Grid Corp + China Southern Power Grid Corp of up to RMB 5trn is estimated at some 40-60% above 14FYP targets/actuals. **Focus** is on: UHV transmission, renewables integration, storage (BESS), distribution (last mile + urban grid) upgrades, AI/DC load growth, and; rural / micro grid resilience.
- **Anti-involution** is lower priority at the moment, and while it remains a key item on the reform agenda, industry capacity utilization is the best guide as to likelihood of more/less interventionist anti-involution agenda.

Key Commodity/Industry Debates

Lithium: Moving toward deficit pricing thanks to a BESS tipping point.

- **EV Demand:** Removal of EV purchase subsidies and imposition of the 5% purchase tax on Jan 1st 2026 has resulted in lower y/y YTD domestic sales, but a ~25% lift in average PV battery size in Mar-Q ytd is significantly offsetting, as is surging e-Truck penetration and the much larger batteries (~200-500KWh) in medium to large size trucks. The surge in EV exports (+84% y/y YTD Jan-Apr) is put down in part to energy price related bring forward, and in part structural growth uplift.
- **BESS Demand:** 15th Five Year Plan features a strong focus on power grid broadening and deepening, with a focus on transmission, distribution and BESS build out to support 3,600GW solar+wind by 2035 (~1,900GW in 2025). BESS

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battery demand could lift from ~25% share of LCE demand in 2025 to ~40% share in 2027/28, or approx. 300kt to 900kt LCE in 2-3yrs.

- **IRRs** need to be >6% for project sanction, and while battery cell costs could lift ~30% with full pass through of RMB 200k/t Li₂CO₃ price, this results in a ~20% lift in module costs and ~10% lift in overall BESS unit costs. ASP of BESS is +5-6% implying less than full pass through of higher prices. New capacity payments introduced in June 2025 offset and add 3-4% to IRRs, helping to explain recent resilience of BESS orders. Increasing intermittent share of generation (= intraday spreads) also help to support IRRs.
- **BESS medium term demand:** One contact outlined ~40% CAGR in BESS installations / shipments, with global installations lifting from 507GWh in 2026 to 1,976GWh in 2030, and shipments (= production) lifting from 1,101GWh in 2026 to 3,034GWh in 2030.
- **LCE Demand:** Bringing EV and BESS demand together, contacts thought LCE demand would lift by 20-29% in 2026 (~25% midpoint), vs UBSe 16%, with top of the range implying ~2.1Mt LCE demand in 2026; while growth to 2029 was estimated at another 60% to ~3Mt.
- **Supply:** China is seen as mixed, with growth in Tibet salt lake projects and Sichuan spodumene offsetting ongoing delays in CATL's mine restart (questions on tailings) and other lepidolite producers in Yichun set to go offline for licensing/permitting/expansion outages lasting ~3-15mths.
- **Zimbabwe** is returning, with Huayou, Sinomine, Yahua and Chengxin all thought to have secured permits for concentrate export resumption while lithium sulphate plants are built.
- **DRC:** Zijin's Manono project in the DRC aims for mine/concentrator completion mid-26, sulphate plant end-26, and full ramp up through 2027 (although the sulphate plant timing is understood to potentially be slipping). Manono East delivers ~70ktpa LCE in spod, and 60ktpa LCE in sulphate, with spod con landing CFR China at US\$400/t. Shipments will be shipped via a Zijin-built road in DRC to Tanzania, then to the Darussalam port for export. From mine gate to refinery in China is 2-3mths. We model 70ktpa LCE from 2027 vs company targets of 130ktpa.
- **Lithium prices:** All contacts were bullish either calling for prices to range at a high level, to remain in deficit and volatile for some time. Some contacts see a supply response in 2027 and potentially slower demand growth, but others see sustained deficits.
- **Anti-involution** is still a theme in parts of the battery chain with significant excess capacity, but has been de-emphasised somewhat.

Copper: Sulphur squeeze looms, while structural electrification demand is strong.

- **Sulphuric acid:** Cost and disrupted supply is being seen as a real risk into 2H. Some 80-90% of DRC production (>2Mtpa) imports acid from the Middle East, a portion has 2-3mths inventory, but potentially 0.8-1.0Mtpa could be impacted if SoH remains choked. Chile has about 20% of production (~1Mtpa) requiring acid, with about 20% (~200ktpa) potentially impacted. Middle East needs 2-3mths to normalise should SoH open.
- In short, **risk to physical copper production is rising.**
- **Demand:** Mixed perspectives. Many cited near term demand risks from energy prices / inflation, but equally boosting electrification related demand (eg: solar, wind, EV, BESS). Accelerating grid spend (15th FYP +40-60% vs 14th FYP), solar, wind, EVs and BESS points to robust medium term demand. AI/DC is a significant tailwind.
- **Supply:** Refined output has accelerated and scrap usage lifted on higher benchmark pricing and tight concentrate supply. Inventory drawdown of blister/anode inventory has also contributed. This may result in deficits in concentrate, in part due to more conventional outages (eg: Grasberg, Cobre Panama, others), but potential balanced or surplus conditions in refined supply.
- **Pricing:** No-one reported a copper buyers strike at recent price levels \$5.50-\$6.00/lb, but several mentioned caution in terms of i) demand risks and ii) positioning. Looking a bit further afield, the combination of disrupted supply and mixed

demand, as Middle East crisis has lifted electrification (eg: solar, wind, EV, BESS) interest but may weigh on traditional demand, was seen as supportive of copper prices trading towards \$6.30-6.80/lb in 2027/28. Tariffs will be a critical factor; positioning into the US importing cathode and storing ahead of potential S.232 tariffs has been a strong tailwind for US copper demand.

- **Strategic / critical minerals:** Increasingly participants view copper of growing strategic importance beyond its more traditional "Dr Copper" role as a gauge of overall economic conditions. Geopolitics, localisation and onshoring were seen to support strategic stockpiles, but estimation of a "strategic premium" to the copper price was seen as elusive for now.
- **Capex/opex:** costs continue to rise, with more stable jurisdictions seeing 3-5% inflation per annum, and more dynamic jurisdictions 5-8%, with both sustaining and new project capex seen with upside risk.
- **Substitution:** Limited clear-cut views on substitution risks from here, with contacts pointing to relatively stable Cu:Al price ratio (both metals used in electrical applications). Some discussion around potential to reduce silver loadings in solar PV manufacture and replace with increased copper loadings

Bauxite / Alumina / Aluminium: "Largest aluminium deficit in decades looms"....

- **Guinea bauxite export quotas:** Export quotas ~150Mt in 2026, vs 183Mt of actual exports in 2025, but the quotas are seen not to have taken effect yet. Equally, large participants are seen as relatively immune, reflecting size and commitment to construct refining capacity.
- **Alumina refinery build out:** Chalco are near completion on their 1.2Mtpa refinery which has taken 7yrs to design/engineer/construct. Bx to Alumina ratio is 2.6-2.7x. [Post trip, Guinea and Chalco agreed a new framework for Chalco's alumina refinery project in Guinea].
- **Alumina balance/outlook:** Market is in surplus, and price outlook muted, and expected to remain that way on i) muted aluminium production growth (Middle East, delays in Indonesia) and ii) ongoing growth in new refinery supply in China, India, Indonesia, and stubborn legacy/high cost capacity.
- **Alumina demand:** Middle East outages of ~2.5Mt smelting capacity is seen taking at least until 2H-2027 to return, while new smelter projects especially in Indonesia (see below) are observed taking more time to build and power.
- **Alumina supply:** Global capacity is estimated ~200Mt that ran ~80% utilisation in 2025 for ~160Mt production. Contacts highlight significant growth in new refining capacity, due in part to project sanction 2023-24 when Russia-Ukraine saw prices spike higher.
 - In China there are >13Mt of new refineries set to open in 2026, and ex-China, almost 17Mt new capacity to open 2026-28. New Chinese capacity is close to the coast for imported bauxite. Cost spreads are meaningful, with breakeven costs typically RMB 2,700-3,000/t inland, vs RMB 2,500-2,600/t on the coast. Inland supply is significantly loss-making, but 60-70% vertically integrated with profitable smelters, so is unlikely to close.
 - The supply dynamic is bearish, with the market expected to remain in a surplus 2026-27.
- **Alumina price outlook:** Contacts saw alumina prices trading into cost curves, but the necessary rebalancing potentially taking longer to materialise. RMB 2,600-2,700/t was seen as a reasonable price expectation in China this year and next, with upside if loss making refiners close in China more rapidly than currently observed / expected.
- **Aluminium demand:** Contacts see underlying demand growth 3-4% p.a. globally, with China towards top of that range and ex-China lower end. Contacts see risk of slower demand from Middle East energy price headwinds to consumption, but equally highlight increased interest in aluminium-intensive solar, BESS and EVs following Middle East conflict, and longer term bullish demand from China's 15th FYP grid spend.
 - **BESS:** Contacts assessed BESS demand (module fabricated framing) could be ~1Mt of Al demand in the near term, growing in line with the rapid expected

lift in BESS production.

- **Aluminium supply:** The outages in Middle East of ~2.5Mt, including EGA's 1.2Mt cold start, could be complicated / take time to bring back on line.
- For some contacts, this results in the **largest aluminium market deficits in decades**, and clearly supportive to price.
- **Indonesia** has 10-14Mt of new aluminium smelter projects in the pipeline, but slow power build out (3-4yrs), fragmented locations/islanded grids, and equipment delays, result in contacts observing a more measured pace of capacity expansion.
- **China 45Mtpa primary capacity cap** is very firm, but advanced technology higher productivity (eg: AP60, 30-40% China capacity) and debottlenecking creep result in selected smelters able to produce between 103-110% of nameplate. Other jurisdictions are now tabling new smelter projects, but longer build/commission times for ex-China capacity mean supply growth may be more rational and not overwhelm strong underlying demand growth.
- **Aluminium substitution:** With the Cu:Al price ratio relatively stable / benign vs historical averages, contacts did not highlight significant substitution pressures in electrical applications in the near term. Contacts did offer potential for Al to steel substitution in select applications in manufacturing and construction for which weight is less of a concern.
- **Aluminium prices:** Current domestic Al prices of RMB24-25k/t are seen as high but reasonable, given where Cu is trading, and robust underlying demand. Pace and direction of inventory movement is important for price, a steady draw was expected by contacts to potentially underpin higher metal prices eg: RMB 26-28k/t on a 6-12mth view. Longer term eg: 2-3yrs, contacts expect supply to catch up to demand and potentially weigh on prices.
- **Aluminium inventory:** In China is not low/tight, indeed it has been a tad elevated in recent months, due to i) rapid price increase, and ii) reduced metal collateralised borrowing. But a recent acceleration in aluminium rod inventory drawdown is supportive, as usually leads broader metal inventory drawdowns by 1-2mths.

Steel / Iron ore: "China's steel bear market is over" & "US\$110/t iron ore is OK"

- **Steel margins:** Some contacts offered that China's steel industry bear market is ending in 2026. The logic flows that current mill margins of RMB 30-90/t, +RMB 300/t from 3mths, ago, are symbolic of an improved cycle.
- Mill margins are better due to i) lower / normalised met coke prices, in part due to higher Mongolian met coal supply, ii) supply discipline eg: maintenance, CO2 emissions pressure, and iii) closing domestic / export price arbitrage.
- While **anti-involution** has been somewhat de-emphasized, capacity reduction requirements remain (1.25:1 for new capacity, 1.5:1 for M&A).
- **Steel demand/production:** Most contacts see production of crude steel flat this year, but manufactured exports (indirect steel exports) are likely to be a bright spot.
- **Manufacturing demand** has grown significantly and including autos & shipping, some saw manufacturing now up to half of overall Chinese domestic steel demand (including amounts exported in manufactured goods).
- **Property construction** steel demand is muted, perhaps one-fifth or less of the ~1Bt annual crude steel output rate. Housing construction is ~10% or less, with the remainder government, commercial, industrial real estate.
- **Infrastructure construction** steel demand is seen growing ~GDP less a little, as while overall infrastructure FAI growth remains healthy, the steel intensity of infrastructure FAI is trending lower.
- **Exports** are mixed. Direct steel exports (125Mt in 2025, of billet, etc) were seen as down or perhaps flat, with anti-dumping and narrowing export arbitrage weighing on shipments (eg: 110-120Mt net exports CY26). But indirect exports (~130-150Mt in 2025) of steel embedded in manufactured goods were seen likely higher by 10-15% y/y, reflecting i) China's lower energy costs, ii) China's relentless lift in quality.
- **Steel scrap:** Availability is OK, but with iron ore prices at US\$110/t, scrap

economics struggle against virgin hot metal. On EAFs, contacts highlighted that EAFs can't compete with BF/BOF at peak power prices, and that some former EAF projects have been delayed/cancelled. Scrap rates into BOFs currently run ~8-15%.

- **Iron ore port stocks:** We asked contacts how to rationalise record iron ore port stocks ~160-165Mt vs iron ore prices ~US\$100-110/t? Most steel mills now hold inventories of iron ore at ports or in trader stocks on their behalf, while traders and producers continue to hold stocks at ports in support of blending operations. In other words, a growing share of iron ore port stocks are effectively steel mill working capital and therefore not indicative of true quantities available to a pure "spot" physical market. Some traders estimate 60%+ of port stocks support blending and mill inventories.
- **Iron ore cost support:** Contacts see cost support at US\$100/t (US\$80/t prior), with higher cost Indian, Chinese domestic and other smaller seaborne supply seen as having left or being in and out of the trade recently. Energy was seen impacting suppliers further from China and those needing energy intensive processing.
- **Iron ore prices:** Some steel mills noted that US\$110/t is "OK", although we suspect subject to mill margins which have been supported by lower met coal prices and normalised average (eg: domestic + export) mill margins.
- **Low grade discounts / high grade premiums.** Mill and producer contacts agreed that if steel mill margins firmed further towards and above RMB 200/t, further pressure would mount on low grade discounts, and potential further expansion of high grade premiums, although the latter is less certain given Middle East DRI/EAF has curtailed.
- **Middle East / Iran impact:** 15-20Mt of exported steel eg: billet, is out of the market, while 10-15Mt of iron ore exports are also out. The result is degree of tightness in steel exports but also the iron ore market.
- **Simandou:** Ramp up is going more slowly, with lack of slots / production of US-manufactured locomotives the key bottleneck. The wet season (Apr-Oct, average rainfall 4.5m at port, 2.5m at mines) is now also impacting. Works continue at both mines, while safety / worker injury increasing focus for the government. Expectations for shipments have been trimmed, with some reducing expected shipments in 2026 from 40-50Mt to 20-30Mt.
- **CMRG:** Contacts expect that other iron ore suppliers eg: RIO, FMG, Vale; will also now need to work through negotiations with CMRG after completion between BHP and CMRG on Jimblebar Fines terms. Issues for debate continue to include Fe realization, impurity discounts, RMB vs USD denomination, and onshore vs offshore price indices.
- **Met coal:** Availability and pricing translating through to met coke costs for blast furnaces has been good, largely due to increased domestic production but also increased imports from Mongolia. The outlook was mixed on tour, with most neutral met coal / coke costs as Mongolia continues to advance its exports; but with the accident in Shanxi over the weekend of 23-24th May, and resultant Shanxi-wide safety inspections, some level of disruption in China domestic supply is likely and probably pushing up met coal prices.

Rare Earths: The Robots (and e-Trucks) are coming...

- **Market & Growth:** ~300kt global NdFeB market, growing ~15%, with high-performance segment outpacing.
- **Demand Mix:** NEVs ~50% of demand, >10% growth outlook; e-trucks drive 2-3x higher magnet intensity. Wind stable; HVAC slowing (~5% EU); robotics emerging high-growth (+85% y/y off low base).
- **Supply & Structure.** Highly China concentrated; limited ex-China substitutes. Capacity expanding (~20% CAGR), but near-term additions modest (e.g. ~5ktpa), limiting oversupply risk.
- **Robotics Upside:** Humanoids: ~3kg REPM/unit, >70 motors; potential for large incremental demand if scaled (~1mn units p.a. scenario).

Nuclear/Uranium: 10 reactors p.a. build out for foreseeable future remains base case...

- **Structural growth supported by policy:** Nuclear remains under-penetrated in

China (~2% capacity / ~5% generation) with explicit policy backing; approvals running at ~6–10 reactors p.a. underpin a multi-decade expansion runway.

- **Accelerating build-out with strong visibility:** Industry capacity expansion is rapid (60-72mths build), with a large construction pipeline; CNNC, for instance, has 26GW operating vs 18GW under construction (expected +70% lift in capacity) and a defined project pipeline through 2031.
- **Generation growth tracking commissioning:** Nuclear output growth (~+9.7% y/y) is broadly aligned with reactor commissioning, illustrating stable execution of capacity additions across the sector.
- **Favourable demand backdrop driving share gains:** Power demand growth of ~5–7% p.a. supports rising nuclear penetration as coal is phased down over the next 5–10 years.
- **Constraints mostly in global delivery capacity:** While China is not materially constrained by capital or labour, global nuclear expansion may be limited by EPC capability and skilled labour availability, creating a potential bottleneck.
- **Emerging technologies offer long-term upside:** SMRs are attractive for distributed energy (power/heat/hydrogen) but currently high capex limits scalability; Gen IV / Fast Breeder Reactors: lower uranium intensity, though early projects remain capital intensive.
- **Fuel and uranium dynamics remain supportive:** Fuel typically ~20% of opex (incl. ~10% uranium); long-term (~10-year) procurement contracts provide demand visibility, with future reactor technologies potentially reducing uranium intensity.

CHINA TRIP ITINERARY

We met with the following contacts in China:

- China National Nuclear Power Group
- UBS China Economics team
- National Development & Reform Commission
- JL Mag Rare Earths
- Sinomine
- Antaike Copper
- Reserve Bank of Australia
- Australian Treasury
- Department of Foreign Affairs & Trade
- China Aluminium Corp
- MMG
- Mysteel Steel & Iron Ore
- Tangshan Steel Traders
- Aladdiny
- Baosteel
- Fortescue Metals
- Trafigura
- CMOG
- Zijin Mining
- Rio Tinto
- Yongxing Materials
- Lantau Group
- Ganfeng Lithium
- CRIC
- ICCSINO (BESS)
- Shangdong Hongqiao
- SMM
- UBS China Solar & BESS team

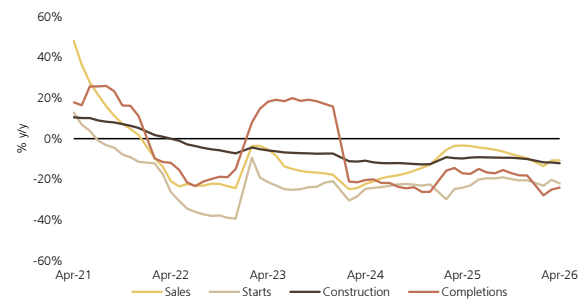
CHINA MACROECONOMIC SIGNALS

Figure 1: China commodity demand signals

		Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	%y/y	%m/m	%YTD	
Business Cycle Indicators																															
NBS Mfg PMI	Index	50.8	50.4	49.5	49.5	49.4	49.1	49.8	50.1	50.3	50.1	49.1	50.2	50.5	49.0	49.5	49.7	49.3	49.4	49.8	49.0	49.2	50.1	49.3	49.0	50.4	50.3	3%	0%		
Caixin Mfg PMI	Index	51.1	51.4	51.7	51.8	49.8	50.4	49.3	50.3	51.5	50.5	50.1	50.8	51.2	50.4	48.3	50.4	49.5	50.5	51.2	50.6	49.9	50.1	50.3	52.1	50.8	52.2	4%	3%		
Steel Industry: Overall	Index	44.2	47.9	49.8	47.8	42.5	40.4	49.0	54.6	50.6	47.5	43.3	45.1	46.0	50.6	46.4	45.9	50.5	49.8	47.7	49.2	48.0	46.3	49.9	46.7	50.6	49.2	-3%	-3%		
Steel Industry: Output	Index	37.7	49.7	50.6	45.9	38.5	34.9	54.8	63.6	53.6	48.3	42.5	45.6	47.1	50.8	42.8	43.5	51.9	48.0	45.7	49.8	45.9	43.7	48.4	46.8	53.3	48.7	-4%	-9%		
Macro Indicators																															
IP Growth (NSA)	% y/y	4.5	6.7	5.6	5.3	5.1	4.5	5.4	5.3	5.4	6.2	5.9	5.9	7.7	6.1	5.8	6.8	5.7	5.2	6.5	4.9	4.8	5.2	6.3	6.3	5.7	4.1	-33%	-28%		
Retail Sales	% y/y	3.1	2.3	3.7	2.0	2.7	2.1	3.2	4.8	3.0	3.7	3.0	3.0	5.9	5.1	6.4	4.8	3.7	3.4	3.0	2.9	1.3	0.9	2.8	2.8	1.7	0.2	-96%	-88%		
Overall FAI	YTD, %yy	4.5	4.2	4.0	3.9	3.6	3.4	3.4	3.4	3.3	3.2		4.1	4.2	4.0	3.7	2.8	1.6	0.5	-0.5	-1.7	-2.6	-3.8			1.8	1.7	-1.6			
Credit & Liquidity																															
China TSF	RMB Tn	4.8	-0.1	2.1	3.3	0.8	3.0	3.8	1.4	2.3	2.9	7.1	2.2	5.9	1.2	2.3	4.2	1.1	2.6	3.5	0.8	2.5	2.2	7.2	2.4	5.2	0.6	-46%	-88%		
RMB Loans (TSF)	RMB Tn	3.3	0.3	0.8	2.2	-0.1	1.0	2.0	0.3	0.5	0.8	5.2	0.7	3.8	0.1	0.6	2.4	-0.4	0.6	1.6	0.0	0.4	1.0	4.9	0.8	3.2	-0.4	-553%	-113%		
M1 Growth	% y/y											0.4	0.1	1.6	1.5	2.3	4.6	5.6	6.0	7.2	6.2	4.9	3.8	4.9	5.9	5.1	5.0				
M2 Growth	% y/y	8.3	7.2	7.0	6.2	6.3	6.3	6.8	7.5	7.1	7.3	7.0	7.0	7.0	8.0	7.9	8.3	8.8	8.8	8.4	8.2	8.0	8.5	9.0	9.0	8.5	8.6	8%	1%		
SHIBOR -3 Month	%	2.2	2.0	2.0	1.9	1.9	1.9	1.8	1.9	1.9	1.7	1.7	1.9	1.9	1.8	1.7	1.6	1.6	1.6	1.6	1.6	1.6	1.6	1.6	1.5	1.4		-19%	-6%		
Commodity Output																															
Crude Steel	Mt	88.3	85.9	92.9	91.6	82.9	77.9	77.1	81.9	78.4	76.0	84.8	81.5	92.8	86.0	86.5	83.2	79.7	77.4	73.5	72.0	69.9	68.2	81.8	78.6	87.0	83.6	-3%	-4%	-4%	
Pig Iron	Mt	72.7	71.6	76.1	74.5	71.4	68.1	66.8	70.3	67.5	66.7	71.8	69.0	75.3	72.6	74.1	71.9	70.8	69.8	66.0	65.5	62.3	60.7	70.2	67.5	73.3	70.7	-3%	-4%	-2%	
Iron Ore (ROM)	Mt	98.1	87.9	88.5	96.6	70.2	73.6	82.8	86.4	81.2	84.9	76.0	82.3	83.5	84.7	85.8	89.0	86.3	81.6	84.3	84.0	83.0	79.3	77.6	84.1	79.6	82.8	-2%	4%	-1%	
Coal	Mt	400.3	370.2	382.1	407.6	391.4	395.2	423.6	416.3	429.9	437.0	402.1	363.2	437.3	382.1	400.6	419.2	374.7	385.9	405.0	403.0	428.5	430.1	400.8	362.0	440.5	380.6	0%	-14%	0%	
Coke	Mt	39.4	38.5	41.0	41.6	41.6	40.9	39.3	41.2	40.7	41.5	41.0	41.0	41.3	41.6	42.4	41.7	41.9	42.6	42.6	41.9	41.7	42.7	41.3	41.3	42.8	41.5	0%	-3%	1%	
Primary Aluminium	Mt	3.59	3.58	3.65	3.67	3.68	3.73	3.65	3.72	3.71	3.77	3.66	3.66	3.75	3.75	3.83	3.81	3.78	3.80	3.81	3.80	3.79	3.87	3.77	3.77	3.85	3.87	3%	0%	3%	
Refined Copper	kt	1147	1136	1089	1128	1103	1121	1138	1116	1133	1242	1150	1150	1248	1254	1254	1302	1270	1301	1266	1204	1236	1326	1237	1330	1269		7%	-5%	6%	
Alumina	Mt	6.8	6.9	7.1	7.2	7.2	7.3	7.3	7.4	7.6	7.5	7.6	7.6	7.5	7.3	7.5	7.7	7.6	7.9	8.0	7.9	8.1	8.0	7.6	7.6	7.6	7.4		2%	-3%	1%
Consumer Appliance Output																															
Refrigerators	m units	9.9	9.3	8.9	8.7	8.3	9.0	9.6	9.0	8.6	9.0	8.0	7.1	9.4	8.2	8.5	9.0	8.7	9.5	10.1	8.8	9.4	10.0	8.8	7.8	10.9	10.1		17%	-8%	15%
Air Conditioners	m units	30.8	30.3	29.1	28.1	20.2	15.0	18.8	16.2	19.7	23.7	21.5	19.8	33.7	30.8	29.5	28.4	20.6	16.8	18.1	14.2	15.0	21.6	20.9	19.3	34.6	28.2		2%	-18%	-3%
Washing Machines	m units	9.3	9.4	9.3	8.2	8.5	10.1	11.0	11.0	11.1	12.3	10.4	8.1	11.0	9.7	9.4	9.5	8.8	10.1	11.8	11.0	12.0	12.0	10.4	8.2	11.6	10.2		5%	-12%	3%
TVs	m units	17.9	17.3	17.0	18.0	16.8	18.3	19.4	17.3	18.2	19.7	15.1	10.5	17.9	16.1	15.8	16.3	15.9	18.0	20.6	18.0	17.4	19.5	14.6	10.1	15.8	14.4		-12%	-9%	-8%
FAI - Selected Sectors																															
Manufacturing	YTD, %yy	9.9	9.7	9.6	9.5	9.3	9.1	9.2	9.3	9.3	9.2		9.0	9.1	8.8	8.5	7.5	6.2	5.1	4.0	2.7	1.9	0.6		3.1	4.1	1.2		-86%		
Infrastructure	YTD, %yy	6.5	6.0	5.7	5.4	4.9	4.4	4.1	4.3	4.2	4.4		5.6	5.8	5.8	5.6	4.6	3.2	2.0	1.1	-0.1	-1.1	-2.2								
Coal Mining Sector	YTD, %yy	32.9	24.9	14.6	16.6	10.5	7.8	5.5	8.6	8.9	9.4		22.6	11.8	14.7	19.9	14.4	13.1	11.5	9.3	7.4	7.6	7.0		23.9	25.5	12.6		-14%		
Steel Sector	YTD, %yy	4.6	7.9	6.5	5.4	6.8	4.9	5.2	4.3	2.8	1.8		5.7	5.5	2.0	-1.6	-0.6	-4.1	-3.3	-2.0	-2.0	-1.3	-2.6		4.3	-0.2	-1.9		-195%		
Autos																															
Motor Vehicle Output	m units	2.8	2.3	2.4	2.6	2.3	2.5	2.8	3.0	3.4	3.5	2.4	2.0	3.0	2.6	2.6	2.8	2.5	2.8	3.2	3.3	3.5	3.4	2.2	1.9	3.1	2.6		-2%	-16%	-4%
NEV Output	10k units (Y	208	294	388	490	589	713	844	990	1,149	1,317	91	182	316	440	564	687	805	938	1,096	1,267	1,453	1,652	80	160	302	429		-3%		
EV Vehicle Output	k units	890	860	940	1020	990	1240	1310	1460	1590	1680	910	910	1340	1240	1240	1230	1180	1330	1580	1710	1860	1990	800	800	1420	1270		2%	-11%	-3%
NEV Output	% y/y	1013%	617%	755%	685%	607%	675%	555%	356%	894%	950%	53%	53%	51%	44%	32%	21%	19%	7%	21%	17%	17%	18%	-12%	-12%	6%	2%				
Inventory Alert Index		58	59	58	62	59	56	54	51	52	50	62	57	55	60	53	57	57	57	55	53	56	58	59	56	58	62		4%	8%	
Real Estate Indicators																															
Under Construction	YTD, msqm	6,785	6,875	6,889	6,968	7,033	7,094	7,160	7,207	7,260	7,332		6,060	6,137	6,203	6,250	6,333	6,387	6,431	6,486	6,529	6,561	6,599		5,354	5,417	5,451		-12%		
New Starts	YTD, msqm	173	235	301	380	437	495	561	612	673	739		66	130	178	232	304	352	398	454	491	535	588		51	104	139		-22%		
Sales	YTD, msqm	227	293	366	479	541	606	703	779	861	974		107	219	283	353	459	516	573	658	720	787	881		93	195	253		-11%		
Completions	YTD, msqm	153	189	222	265	300	334	368	420	482	737		88	131	156	184	226	250	277	311	349	395	603		63	98	119		-24%		
Under Construction	YTD, %yy	-11%	-13%	-16%	-17%	-18%	-19%	-21%	-22%			-5%	-9%	-10%	-10%	-9%	-9%	-9%	-9%	-9%	-9%	-10%	-10%		-12%	-12%	-12%		24%		
New Starts	YTD, %yy	-75%	-76%	-75%	-73%	-73%	-73%	-72%	-73%		334%		-30%	-25%	-24%	-23%	-20%	-19%	-20%	-19%	-20%	-21%	-20%		-23%	-20%	-22%		-9%		
Sales	YTD, %yy	-53%	-58%	-56%	-51%	-54%	-55%	-53%	-56%		461%		-5%	-4%	-3%	-4%	-4%	-5%	-5%	-6%	-8%	-9%	-10%		-14%	-11%	-11%		214%		
Completions	YTD, %yy	-36%	-35%	-33%	-29%	-27%	-32%	-38%	-54%		445%		-16%	-14%	-17%	-17%	-15%	-17%	-17%	-15%	-17%	-18%	-18%		-28%	-25%	-24%		41%		
Electricity Generation																															
Total Electricity Producti	Twh	748	690	718	769	883	907	802	731	750	846	821	671	778	711	738	796	927	936	826	800	779	859	864	707	802	744		3%	-7%	5%
Thermal Power	Twh	520	458	454	487	575	615	545	477	517	598	562	460	510	449	461	494	602	627	517	514	497	581	580	474	533	464		4%	-13%	4%
Hydro Power	Twh	71	83	115	144	166	163	120	105	82	83	79	67	78	79	99	139	151	148	159	135	97	87	84	72	86	88		10%	2%	9%
Nuclear	Twh	35	37	36	36	40	40	36	37	38	42	40	35	43	41	38	39	43	43	36	39	40	45	40	35	38	38		-12%	-1%	-5%
Wind	Twh	91	81	77	67	66	50	69	80	82	92	92	85	105	97	92	74	74	65	67	73	105	104	101	93	91	97		-13%	7%	1%

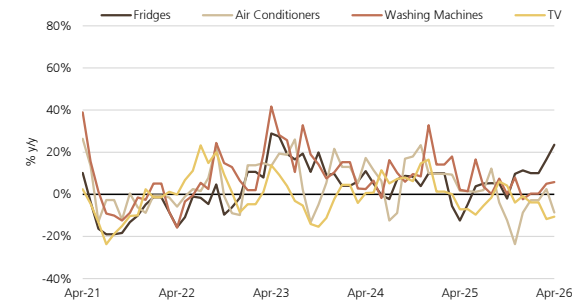
CHINA MACROECONOMIC SIGNALS

Figure 2: China Property Indicators



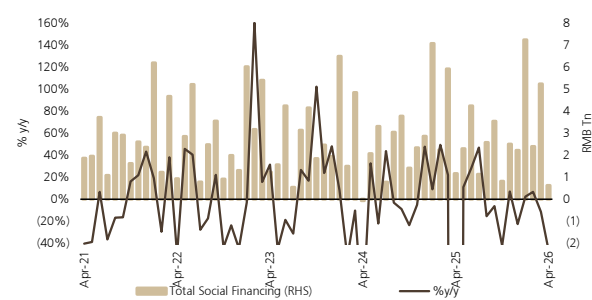
Source: China NBS, Haver

Figure 3: Appliance Output



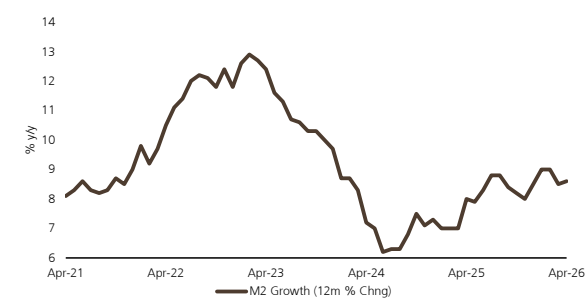
Source: China NBS, Haver

Figure 4: TSF Flows



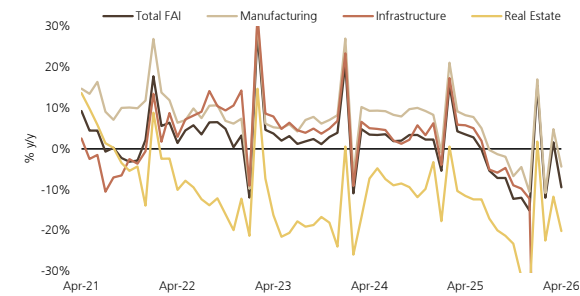
Source: China NBS, Haver

Figure 5: Money Growth



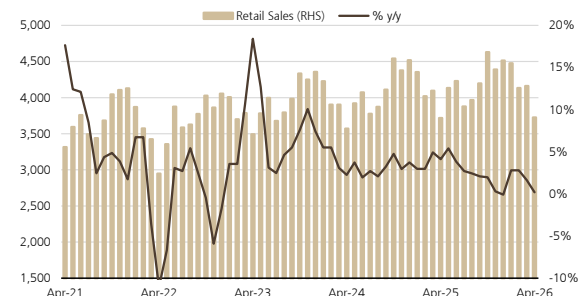
Source: PBOC, Haver

Figure 6: Total FAI by sector – y/y% YTD



Source: China NBS, Haver

Figure 7: Retail Sales



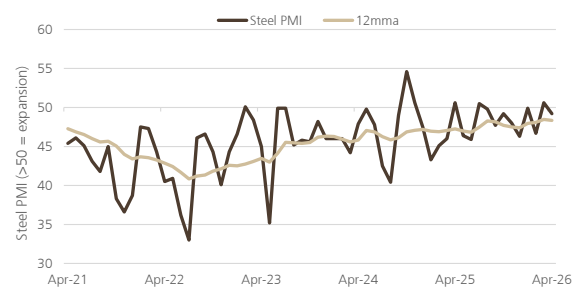
Source: China NBS, Haver

Figure 8: China Manufacturing PMI



Source: China NBS, Haver

Figure 9: China Steel PMI



Source: China NBS, Haver

CHINA KEY TRADE FLOWS

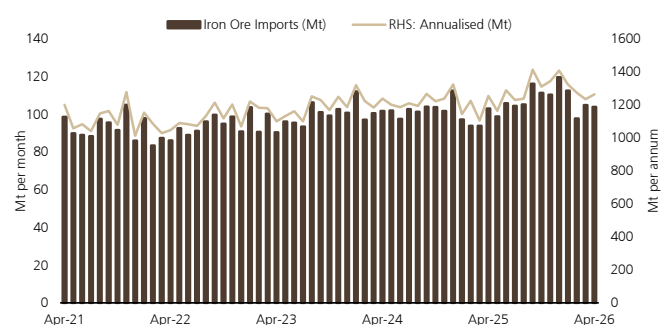
Figure 10: China Key Trade Flows

		May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	%yly	%m/m	%YTD
Iron Ore Imports	Mt	101.9	97.4	102.6	101.3	103.9	103.7	101.7	112.4	97.2	93.8	93.8	102.9	98.7	105.8	104.4	105.0	116.1	111.2	110.3	119.5	112.4	97.6	104.7	103.8	1%	-1%	8%
Annualised Iron Ore Imports	Mt	1223	1169	1232	1215	1247	1244	1220	1349	1166	1126	1125	1235	1185	1270	1252	1261	1393	1334	1324	1434	1349	1172	1257	1246			
Steel Exports	Mt	9.5	8.7	7.8	9.4	10.1	11.2	9.3	9.7	8.9	8.0	10.5	10.5	10.6	9.7	9.8	9.5	10.5	9.8	10.0	11.3	7.8	7.8	9.1	9.5	-9%	4%	-10%
Annualised Steel Exports	Mt	114	105	93	113	121	134	111	117	107	96	125	126	127	116	118	114	126	117	120	136	93	94	110	114			
Steel Imports	Mt	0.6	0.6	0.5	0.5	0.6	0.5	0.5	0.6	0.5	0.6	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.6	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.4	0.5	0.5	-12%	-10%	-14%
Annualised Steel Imports	Mt	7.7	6.9	6.1	6.1	6.6	6.4	5.7	7.5	6.0	6.7	6.0	6.3	5.6	5.6	5.4	6.0	6.7	6.1	6.0	6.2	5.5	4.4	6.1	5.5			
Net Steel Exports	Mt	8.8	8.2	7.3	8.9	9.5	10.6	8.8	9.1	8.4	7.5	10.0	9.9	10.1	9.2	9.4	9.0	9.9	9.3	9.5	10.8	7.3	7.5	8.6	9.0	-9%	5%	-9%
Annualised Net Steel Exports	Mt	106	98	87	107	115	127	106	109	101	90	119	119	121	110	113	108	119	111	114	129	87	90	103	108			
Coal Imports	Mt	43.8	44.5	46.2	45.8	47.6	46.2	55.0	52.3	41.8	34.3	38.7	37.8	36.1	33.0	35.6	42.6	45.9	41.7	44.1	58.6	46.3	30.9	39.1	33.1	-12%	-15%	-2%
Annualised Coal Imports	Mt	526	535	555	550	571	554	660	628	501	412	465	453	433	396	427	512	551	501	529	703	555	371	469	397			
Copper Concentrate Imports	Mt	2.25	2.31	2.16	2.57	2.43	2.31	2.23	2.52	2.53	2.17	2.39	2.91	2.41	2.35	2.56	2.74	2.58	2.45	2.52	2.70	2.62	2.31	2.63	2.35	-19%	-11%	-1%
Annualised Copper Concentrate Imports	Mt	27.0	27.7	25.9	30.8	29.2	27.7	26.8	30.2	30.4	26.1	28.7	34.9	28.9	28.2	30.7	32.9	31.0	29.4	30.3	32.4	31.4	27.8	31.5	28.2			
Copper Metal Imports	Kt	512	436	437	414	479	506	528	559	420	414	469	435	431	464	480	423	483	437	424	440	380	320	415	455	5%	10%	-10%
Annualised Copper Metal Imports	Kt	6144	5229	5244	4968	5747	6073	6336	6708	5040	4968	5628	5220	5170	5570	5760	5076	5791	5249	5088	5280	4560	3840	4980	5460			
Aluminium Exports	Mt	0.56	0.61	0.59	0.59	0.56	0.58	0.67	0.51	0.49	0.37	0.51	0.52	0.55	0.49	0.54	0.53	0.52	0.50	0.57	0.54	0.54	0.43	0.49	0.59	15%	22%	9%
Annualised Aluminium Exports	Mt	6.77	7.32	7.03	7.13	6.74	6.92	8.03	6.07	5.88	4.45	6.07	6.22	6.54	5.86	6.53	6.41	6.24	6.04	6.83	6.49	6.48	5.17	5.82	7.13			
Crude Oil Imports	Mt	47.0	46.4	42.3	49.1	45.5	44.7	48.5	47.7	41.2	42.6	51.1	48.0	46.7	49.8	47.2	49.5	46.9	48.0	50.9	55.9	48.9	48.0	49.9	38.5	-20%	-23%	1%
Annualised Crude Oil Imports	Mt	564	557	508	589	546	536	582	572	494	511	614	576	561	597	566	594	563	576	610	670	587	577	599	461			
Rare Earths Exports	Kmt	6.2	4.8	4.9	4.7	4.2	4.8	4.4	3.3	5.3	3.2	5.7	4.8	5.9	7.7	6.0	5.8	4.0	4.3	5.5	4.4	6.1	4.4	4.1	5.3	11%	29%	5%
Annualised Rare Earths Exports	Kmt	75	58	59	57	50	57	53	40	63	39	68	57	70	93	72	69	48	52	66	53	73	53	49	64			

Source: Haver, Bloomberg, UBS Research

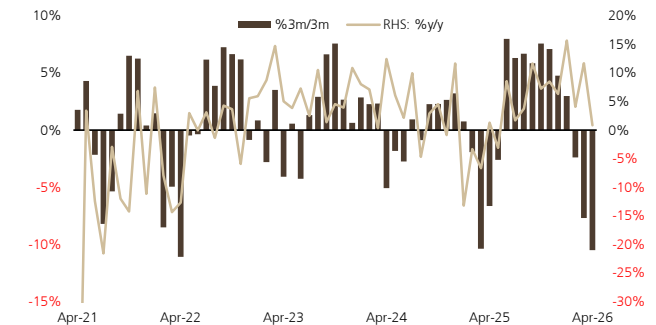
CHINA TRADE SIGNALS

Figure 11: Iron Ore Imports - mthly and ann'd



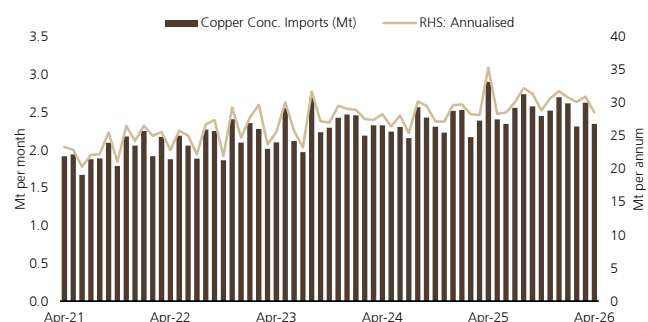
Source: Haver, UBS Research

Figure 12: Iron Ore Imports - %3m/3m and %y/y



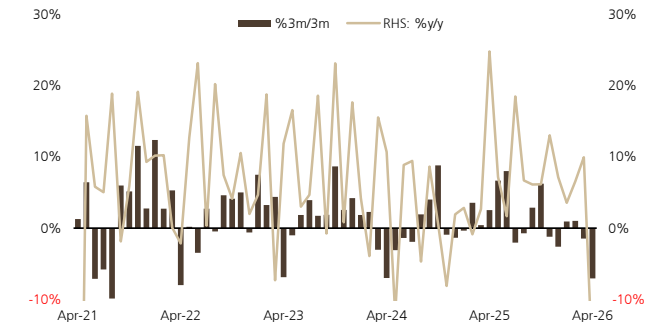
Source: Haver, UBS Research

Figure 13: Copper Concentrate Imports - mthly and ann'd



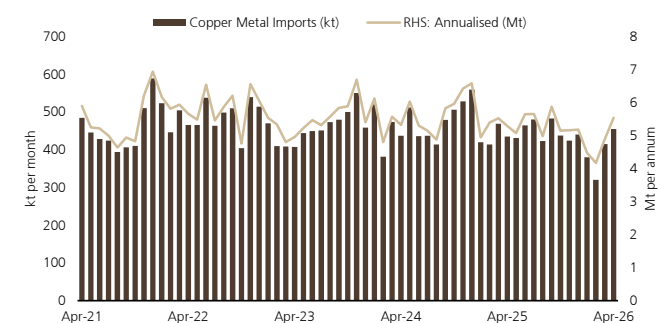
Source: Haver, UBS Research

Figure 14: Copper Concentrate Imports - %3m/3m and %y/y



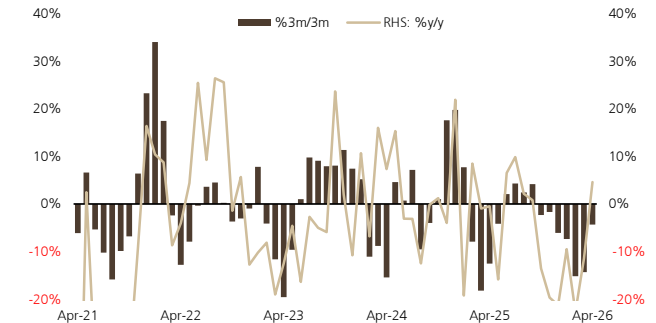
Source: Haver, UBS Research

Figure 15: Copper Metal Imports - mthly and ann'd



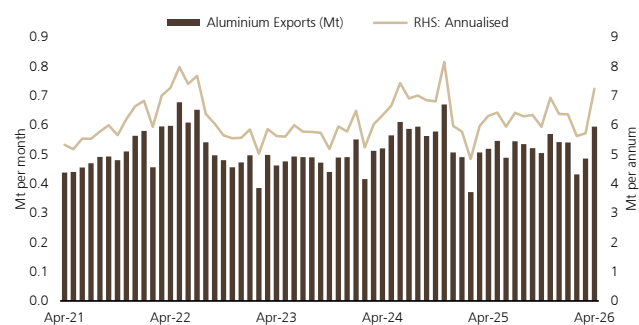
Source: Haver, UBS Research

Figure 16: Copper Metal Imports - %3m/3m and %y/y



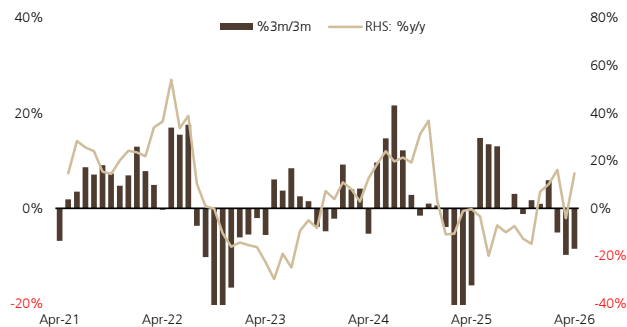
Source: Haver, UBS Research

Figure 17: Aluminium Exports - mthly and ann'd



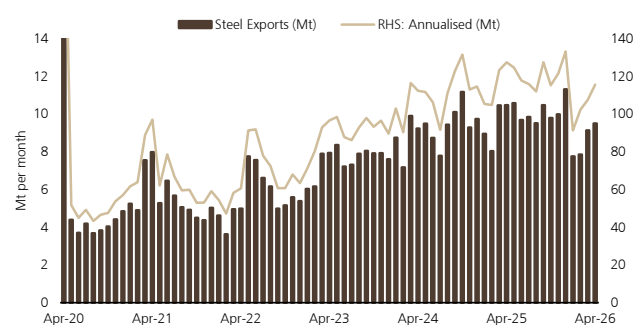
Source: Haver, UBS Research

Figure 18: Aluminium Exports - %3m/3m and %y/y



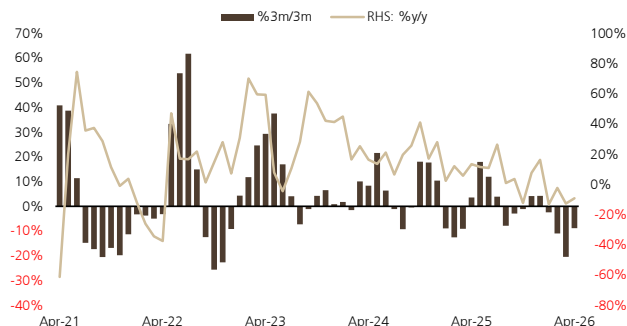
Source: Haver, UBS Research

Figure 19: Net Steel Exports - mthly & ann'd



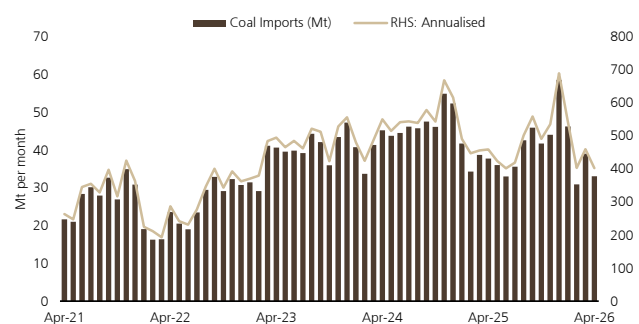
Source: Haver, UBS Research

Figure 20: Net Steel Exports - %3m/3m and %y/y



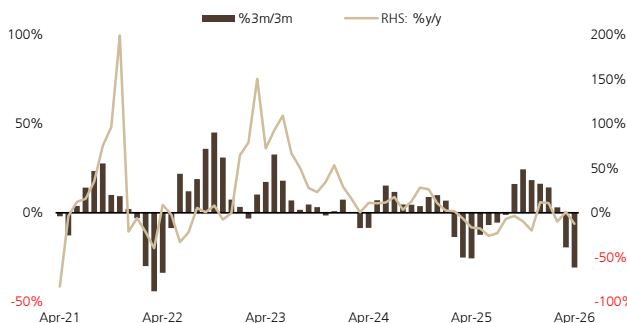
Source: Haver, UBS Research

Figure 21: Coal Imports - mthly and ann'd



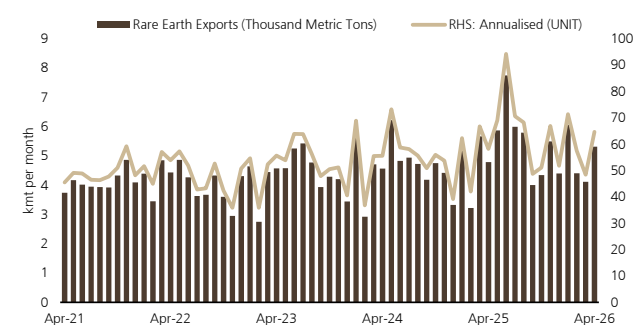
Source: Haver, UBS Research

Figure 22: Coal Imports - %3m/3m and %y/y



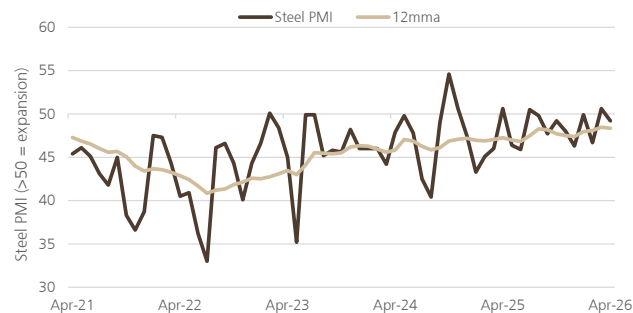
Source: Haver, UBS Research

Figure 23: Rare Earth Exports - mthly and ann'd



Source: Haver, UBS Research

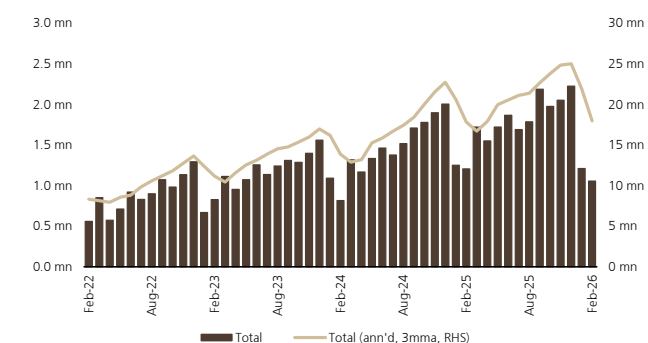
Figure 24: Rare Earth Exports - %3m/3m and %y/y



Source: Haver, UBS Research

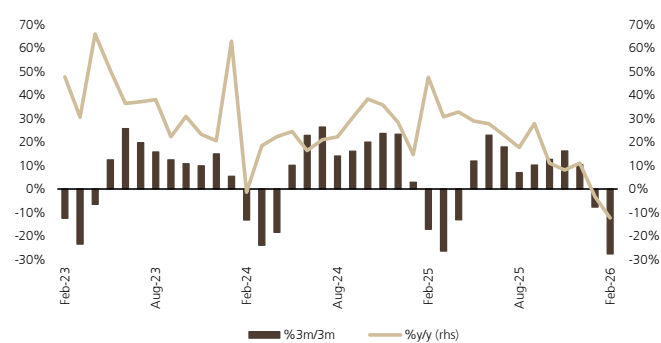
GLOBAL EV AND EV BATTERY SIGNALS

Figure 25: Global EV sales - mthly & ann'd



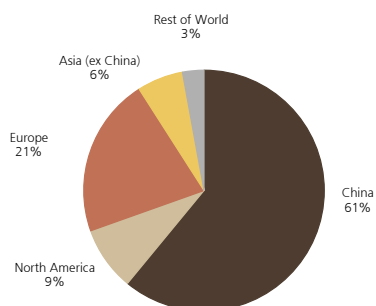
Source: Benchmark Mineral Intelligence, UBS

Figure 26: Global EV sales - %3m/3m & %y/y



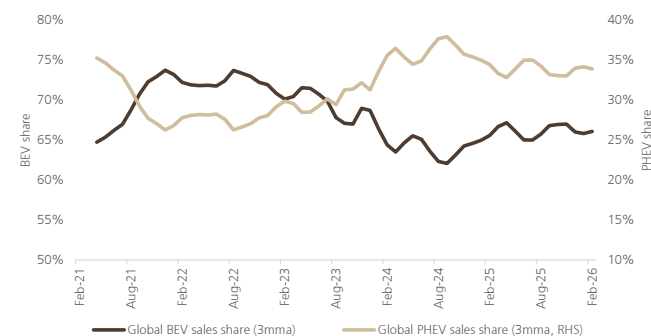
Source: Benchmark Mineral Intelligence, UBS

Figure 27: Passenger & light commercial vehicle sales by country/region - last 12mths



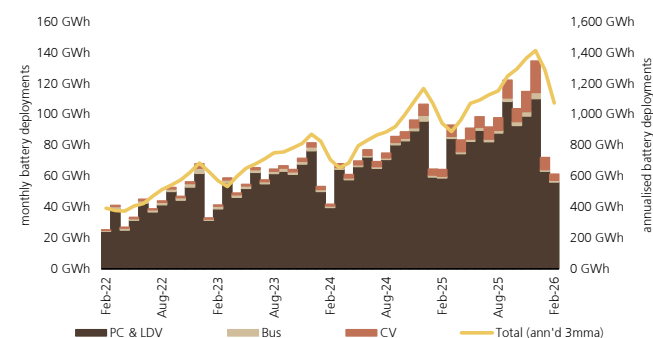
Source: Benchmark Mineral Intelligence, UBS

Figure 28: Global EV sales - BEV vs PHEV share



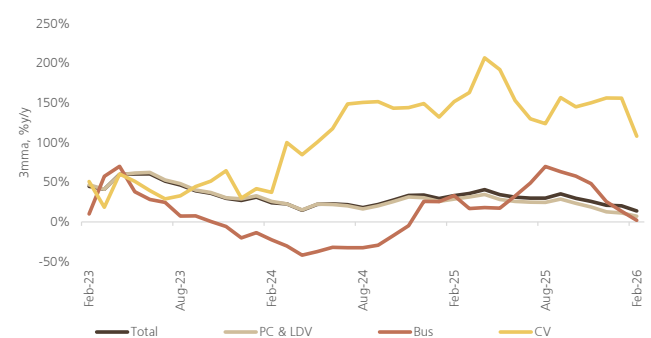
Source: Benchmark Mineral Intelligence, UBS

Figure 29: EV battery deployments by vehicle type - passenger, bus & commercial vehicle



Source: Benchmark Mineral Intelligence, UBS

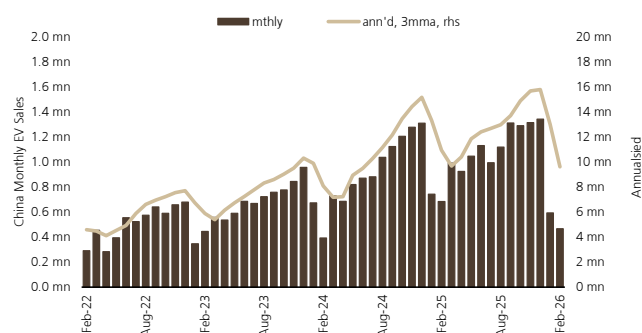
Figure 30: EV battery sales by vehicle type - %3m/3m & %y/y



Source: Benchmark Mineral Intelligence, UBS

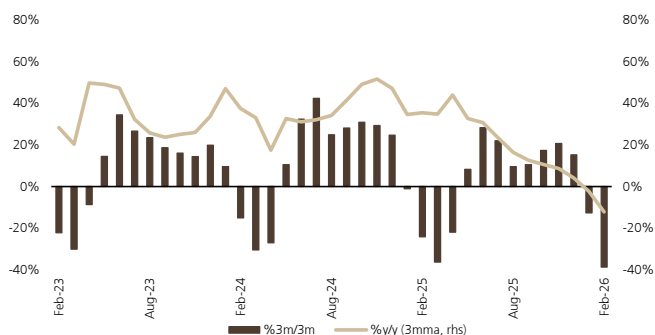
GLOBAL EV AND EV BATTERY SIGNALS

Figure 31: China EV sales - mthly & ann'd



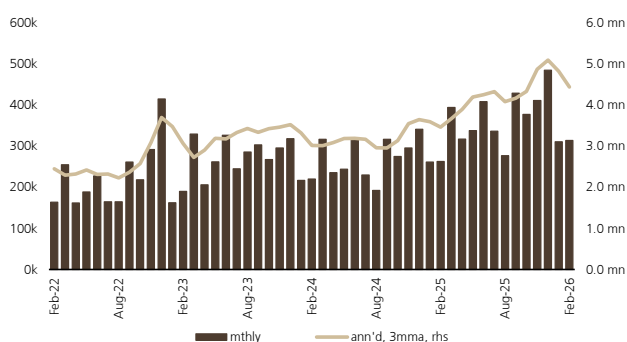
Source: Benchmark Mineral Intelligence, UBS

Figure 32: China EV sales - %3m/3m & %y/y



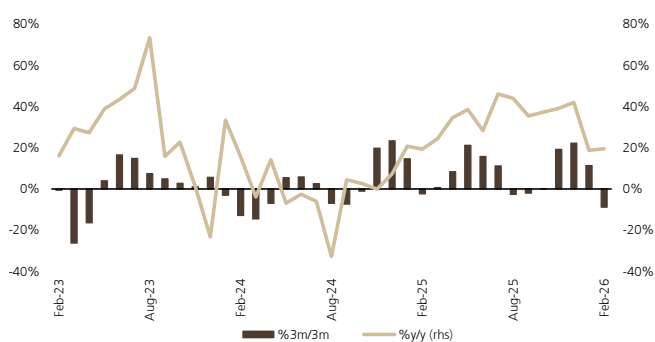
Source: Benchmark Mineral Intelligence, UBS

Figure 33: Europe EV sales - mthly & ann'd



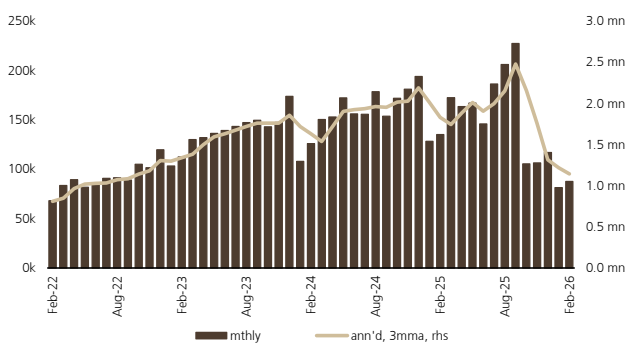
Source: Benchmark Mineral Intelligence, UBS

Figure 34: Europe EV sales - %3m/3m & %y/y



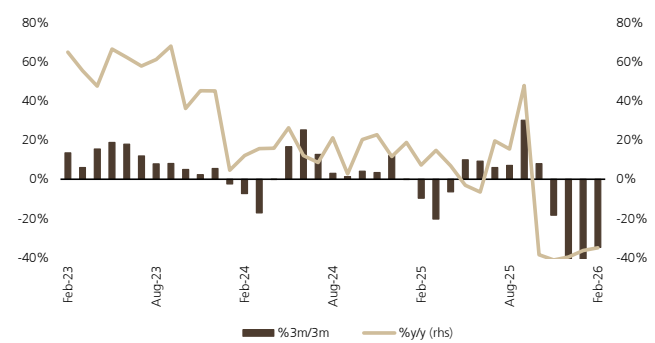
Source: Benchmark Mineral Intelligence, UBS

Figure 35: Nth America EV sales - mthly & ann'd



Source: Benchmark Mineral Intelligence, UBS

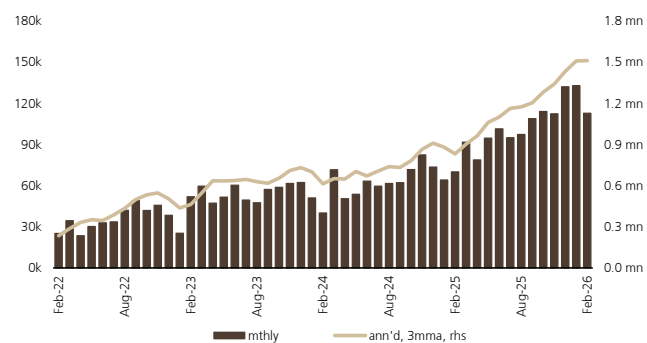
Figure 36: Nth America EV sales - %3m/3m & %y/y



Source: Benchmark Mineral Intelligence, UBS

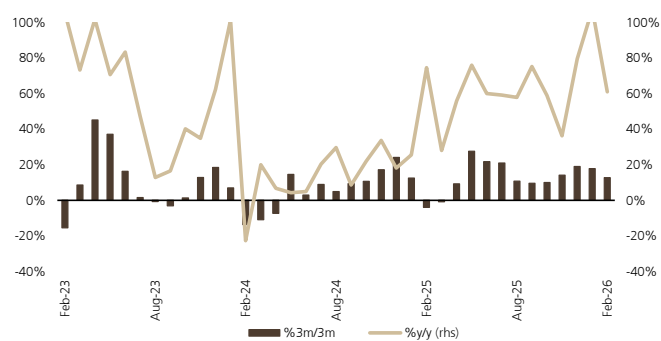
GLOBAL EV AND EV BATTERY SIGNALS

Figure 37: APAC ex-China EV sales - mthly & ann'd



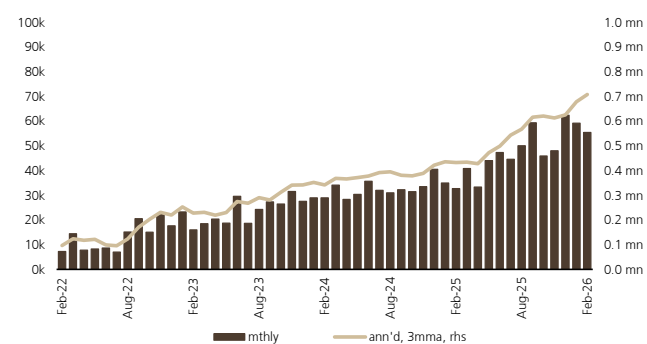
Source: Benchmark Mineral Intelligence, UBS

Figure 38: APAC ex-China sales - %3m/3m & %y/y



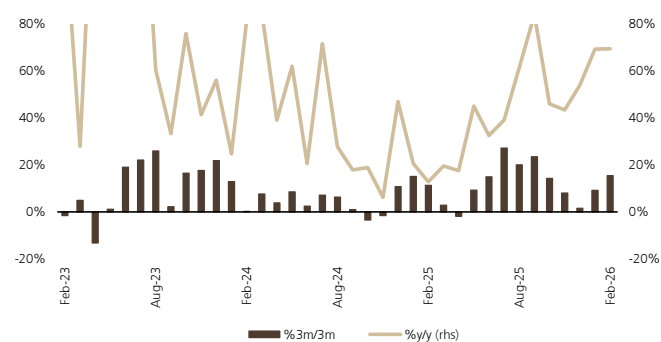
Source: Benchmark Mineral Intelligence, UBS

Figure 39: Rest of World EV sales - mthly & ann'd



Source: Benchmark Mineral Intelligence, UBS

Figure 40: Rest of World EV sales - %3m/3m & %y/y



Source: Benchmark Mineral Intelligence, UBS

Figure 41: Iron Ore Model

IRON ORE MODEL Global Commodities & Mining										
Iron Ore Supply-Demand Balance	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025e	2026e	2027e	2028e	2029e	2030e
Crude Steel Output										
China	1,033	1,018	1,029	1,005	1,011	1,001	995	989	979	968
Japan	96	89	87	84	81	78	76	76	76	76
South Korea	70	66	67	64	61	61	61	61	61	61
Taiwan	23	21	19	19	18	19	19	19	19	19
India	118	125	141	149	164	176	186	197	209	222
EU	205	182	170	175	175	187	174	198	203	208
Others	417	388	392	387	367	361	372	371	378	386
Total	1,963	1,889	1,904	1,883	1,877	1,883	1,882	1,910	1,924	1,939
% y/y	4%	-4%	1%	-1%	0%	0%	0%	1%	1%	1%
Hot Metal Output										
China	869	865	874	855	867	859	853	838	820	801
Japan	70	64	63	61	59	57	55	55	55	55
South Korea	46	43	45	44	42	42	42	42	42	42
Taiwan	15	13	12	12	11	12	12	12	12	12
India	117	122	136	145	159	170	180	191	203	215
EU	98	87	79	80	80	86	80	91	93	96
Others	253	235	241	241	220	212	218	216	220	225
Global Hot Metal Output	1,470	1,430	1,450	1,438	1,439	1,438	1,441	1,445	1,445	1,445
% y/y	3%	-3%	1%	-1%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Iron Ore Imports => Demand										
China	1,120	1,106	1,178	1,238	1,266	1,253	1,254	1,249	1,231	1,201
Japan	113	104	102	96	88	85	82	82	82	82
South Korea	74	66	68	69	65	65	65	65	65	65
Taiwan	25	23	19	20	18	19	19	19	19	19
EU	134	117	107	105	105	113	105	119	122	125
Others	123	118	124	126	109	105	108	121	137	153
Total	1,589	1,534	1,600	1,656	1,652	1,640	1,633	1,656	1,657	1,646
% y/y	1.1%	-3.5%	4.3%	3.5%	-0.2%	-0.7%	-0.4%	1.4%	0.0%	-0.6%
Demand impulse mt y/y	18	-55	66	56	-4	-12	-6	22	1	-10
				8%						
Iron Ore Exports => Supply										
Australia	919	929	932	933	952	970	980	992	1,001	1,000
Brazil	357	344	380	391	420	425	435	448	464	473
South Africa	67	58	59	57	57	57	53	53	55	57
India	36	16	44	44	25	11	1	-	-	-
North America	71	68	70	72	71	90	94	96	95	95
Africa	18	23	23	26	34	63	102	143	161	161
Ukraine	44	24	18	34	31	22	22	29	36	43
Others	155	143	159	158	153	156	160	162	163	161
Total	1,668	1,605	1,685	1,714	1,743	1,794	1,847	1,923	1,974	1,991
% y/y	0.6%	-3.7%	5.0%	1.7%	1.7%	2.9%	3.0%	4.1%	2.7%	0.9%
Supply impulse mt y/y	11	-63	80	28	29	51	53	76	51	17
Supply impulse - Demand impulse r	-7	-7	15	-28	33	63	60	54	50	27
Unadjusted Seaborne Balance	78	71	86	58	91	154	214	267	318	345
Adjustment factor	2.9%	5.8%	6.2%	1.6%	5.0%	5.0%	5.0%	5.0%	5.0%	5.0%
China port inventory, chge	29	-22	-19	30	4					
China domestic production	295	286	284	288	278	268	258	238	228	228
Iron Ore Fines 62% CFR China	160	121	120	110	102	100	95	92	95	96
Iron Ore Lump 62% CFR China	182	136	129	118	111	109	104	104	109	110

Source: Woodmac, UBS estimates

Figure 42: Steel Model

China	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E
Capacity	1,149	1,148	1,147	1,150	1,142	1,148	1,150	1,150	1,150	1,150	1,150	1,150
yoy growth	2%	0%	0%	0%	-1%	1%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Production - crude steel	995	1,065	1,033	1,018	1,029	1,018	1,011	1,001	995	989	979	968
yoy growth	7.2%	7.0%	-3.0%	-1.4%	1.1%	-1.1%	-0.7%	-1.0%	-0.6%	-0.6%	-1.0%	-1.2%
Utilisation rate	87%	93%	90%	89%	90%	89%	88%	87%	87%	86%	85%	84%
Net exports	-48	-14	-38	-51	-83	-108	-127	-130	-125	-124	-118	-112
Consumption	950	1,051	994	965	943	892	879	866	865	860	857	852
yoy growth	9.1%	10.6%	-5.4%	-2.9%	-2.3%	-5.4%	-1.5%	-1.5%	-0.1%	-0.5%	-0.4%	-0.6%
World ex-China	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E
Capacity	1,264	1,273	1,281	1,309	1,291	1,324	1,373	1,422	1,455	1,470	1,488	1,513
yoy growth	1%	1%	1%	2%	-1%	3%	4%	4%	2%	1%	1%	2%
Production - crude steel	880	816	930	872	875	872	865	879	901	921	945	971
yoy growth	-2.1%	-7.3%	14.0%	-6.3%	0.4%	-0.4%	-0.7%	1.5%	2.6%	2.2%	2.6%	2.7%
Utilisation rate	70%	64%	73%	67%	68%	66%	63%	62%	62%	63%	64%	64%
Net imports	50	7	23	49	72	98	127	130	125	124	118	112
Consumption	941	848	967	925	949	964	991	1,012	1,033	1,052	1,069	1,089
yoy growth	-2%	-10%	14%	-4.3%	3%	2%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%
World	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E
Capacity	2,413	2,421	2,427	2,459	2,432	2,472	2,523	2,573	2,605	2,621	2,638	2,664
yoy growth	1%	0%	0%	1%	-1%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Production - crude steel	1,875	1,880	1,963	1,889	1,904	1,889	1,877	1,880	1,896	1,910	1,925	1,939
yoy growth	2.7%	0.3%	4.4%	-3.7%	0.8%	-0.8%	-0.7%	0.2%	0.9%	0.7%	0.8%	0.7%
Utilisation rate	78%	78%	81%	77%	78%	76%	74%	73%	73%	73%	73%	73%
Net imports	2	-7	-15	-2	-11	-11	0	0	0	0	0	0
Consumption	1,890	1,898	1,961	1,891	1,892	1,856	1,870	1,878	1,898	1,912	1,926	1,941
yoy growth	3%	0%	3%	-4%	0%	-2%	1%	0%	1%	1%	1%	1%

Source: World Steel, WoodMac, UBS estimates

Figure 43: Metallurgical Coal Model

		2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E
Crude Steel Output												
China	Mt	1,065	1,033	1,018	1,029	1,005	1,011	1,001	995	989	979	968
India	Mt	100	118	125	141	149	164	176	186	197	209	222
Japan	Mt	83	96	89	87	84	81	78	76	76	76	76
South Korea	Mt	67	70	66	67	64	61	61	61	61	61	61
Taiwan	Mt	21	23	21	19	19	18	19	19	19	19	19
Europe	Mt	200	226	188	176	182	181	193	180	204	209	214
Asia Pacific	Mt	55	67	63	62	63	64	66	69	71	74	77
Others	Mt	289	329	319	323	317	297	289	297	293	298	303
Global Crude Steel Production	Mt	1,880	1,963	1,889	1,904	1,883	1,877	1,883	1,882	1,910	1,924	1,939
% y/y	%	0%	4%	-4%	1%	-1%	0%	0%	0%	1%	1%	1%
Global Hot Metal Production	Mt	1,332	1,348	1,301	1,349	1,322	1,343	1,346	1,341	1,342	1,341	1,337
% y/y	%	0%	1%	-3%	4%	-2%	2%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Global Met Coal Production	Mt	1,119	1,126	1,106	1,109	1,107	1,118	1,115	1,106	1,103	1,096	1,085
% y/y	%	-2%	1%	-2%	0%	0%	1%	0%	-1%	0%	-1%	-1%
Met Coal Import Demand												
China	Mt	59	51	48	66	77	70	52	49	48	45	45
India	Mt	57	60	69	72	75	78	86	91	97	101	106
Japan	Mt	55	58	56	54	49	47	46	45	44	43	42
South Korea	Mt	33	35	33	33	36	33	32	32	32	32	31
Taiwan	Mt	10	11	10	10	10	9	9	9	9	9	9
Europe	Mt	49	54	48	44	45	44	49	41	48	48	49
Asia Pacific	Mt	15	16	17	19	25	26	32	35	38	41	44
Others	Mt	17	19	17	18	16	16	11	11	11	12	13
Total Seaborne Import Demand	Mt	294	303	299	315	333	324	317	313	327	331	339
% y/y	%	-4%	3%	-1%	6%	6%	-3%	-2%	-1%	4%	1%	2%
Met Coal Export Supply												
Australia	Mt	172	167	160	151	153	147	155	160	161	165	169
Canada	Mt	27	27	28	31	30	31	30	30	31	31	33
US	Mt	37	38	41	44	49	45	49	51	46	47	46
Russia	Mt	36	43	48	64	65	65	52	53	54	54	54
Others	Mt	15	17	18	22	28	33	28	28	29	29	33
Total Seaborne Export Supply	Mt	287	293	295	311	326	322	314	322	321	326	336
% y/y	%	-9%	2%	1%	6%	5%	-1%	-2%	2%	0%	2%	3%
HCC	Mt	165	166	168	178	187	187	186	192	195	198	205
SCC	Mt	70	73	73	77	78	75	71	71	68	68	69
PCI	Mt	53	54	54	57	61	60	58	58	58	60	61
Seaborne Balance	Mt	-7	-10	-3	-4	-7	-2	-3	8	-6	-5	-3
Hard coking coal price	US\$/t	124	225	366	296	241	188	230	225	230	235	240
Low volatile PCI price	US\$/t	78	163	332	219	165	141	158	155	170	174	178
Semi-soft coking coal price	US\$/t	69	154	287	194	144	116	144	141	144	147	150
China Met Coal Market												
China Crude Steel Production		1,065	1,033	1,018	1,029	1,005	1,011	1,001	995	989	979	968
	%	7%	-3%	-1%	1%	-2%	1%	-1%	-1%	-1%	-1%	-1%
Pig Iron Production		901	866	865	910	885	908	901	892	878	863	844
	%	6%	-4%	0%	5%	-3%	3%	-1%	-1%	-2%	-2%	-2%
Domestic Met Coal Production		720	712	697	666	640	621	597	575	555	533	513
	%	2%	-1%	-2%	-4%	-4%	-3%	-4%	-4%	-3%	-4%	-4%
Met Coal Imports		59	51	48	66	77	70	52	49	48	45	45
	%	25%	-14%	-6%	37%	17%	-9%	-26%	-5%	-2%	-7%	2%
Pig Iron - Met Coal Ratio		0.86	0.88	0.86	0.80	0.81	0.80	0.80	0.80	0.79	0.79	0.78
	%	-2%	2%	-2%	-7%	0%	0%	-1%	-1%	-1%	-1%	-1%

Source: UBS estimates

Figure 44: Copper Model

		COPPER MODEL										
		Global Commodities & Mining										
		2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
Mine Production												
Chile	Kt	5,793	5,660	5,358	5,265	5,555	5,333	5,337	5,380	5,726	5,627	5,789
Peru	Kt	2,135	2,282	2,411	2,724	2,640	2,697	2,841	2,698	2,706	2,659	2,551
DRC	Kt	1,719	2,016	2,437	2,650	3,171	3,132	3,336	3,470	3,556	3,692	3,741
Zambia	Kt	852	826	784	701	740	846	986	1,020	1,115	1,162	1,191
USA	Kt	1,227	1,264	1,261	1,159	1,093	1,163	1,258	1,311	1,272	1,147	1,118
Mexico	Kt	728	705	700	704	721	744	760	706	676	669	623
Other	Kt	8,484	8,694	9,122	9,105	9,106	9,189	9,876	10,450	10,771	11,102	11,293
Mine Supply	Kt	20,939	21,448	22,073	22,308	23,027	23,105	24,393	25,034	25,822	26,058	26,307
Disruption	Kt	0	0	0	0	0	0	1,225	1,250	1,300	1,300	1,325
Mine Supply	Kt	20,939	21,448	22,073	22,308	23,027	23,105	23,168	23,784	24,522	24,758	24,982
Change y/y	%	0.6%	2.4%	2.9%	1.1%	3.2%	0.3%	0.3%	2.7%	3.1%	1.0%	0.9%
Refined Production												
Concentrate	Kt	17,523	18,043	18,379	18,735	19,414	19,579	19,752	20,505	21,285	21,483	21,746
Secondary Scrap (net)	Kt	2,984	3,494	3,201	3,554	3,862	4,781	4,988	5,135	5,289	5,431	5,591
Refinery Output	Kt	20,507	21,537	21,580	22,289	23,276	24,360	24,741	25,640	26,574	26,914	27,337
SXEW	Kt	3,543	3,425	3,607	3,570	3,626	3,576	3,421	3,277	3,246	3,272	3,246
Total Refined	Kt	24,050	24,963	25,188	25,858	26,903	27,936	28,161	28,918	29,819	30,186	30,583
Change	%	1.7%	3.8%	0.9%	2.7%	4.0%	3.8%	0.8%	2.7%	3.1%	1.2%	1.3%
Demand												
China	Kt	14,795	15,329	15,483	16,600	17,308	17,887	18,110	18,579	19,098	19,668	20,193
Europe	Kt	4,781	5,357	5,329	4,974	5,020	5,083	5,238	5,428	5,631	5,828	6,056
North America	Kt	2,789	3,123	3,067	2,896	3,007	3,117	3,295	3,521	3,756	4,011	4,283
Other Asia	Kt	4,337	4,732	4,605	4,352	4,457	4,581	4,706	4,861	5,017	5,161	5,263
Other	Kt	2,824	3,081	3,320	3,383	3,543	3,692	3,821	3,998	4,188	4,386	4,588
Total Demand	Kt	29,526	31,622	31,805	32,204	33,335	34,361	35,169	36,387	37,690	39,053	40,382
Change y/y	%	-1.9%	7.1%	0.6%	1.3%	3.5%	3.1%	2.4%	3.5%	3.6%	3.6%	3.4%
Direct Use Scrap	Kt	5,518	6,683	6,593	6,311	6,553	6,572	6,847	7,202	7,577	8,000	8,400
Change y/y	%	-12.3%	21.1%	-1.3%	-4.3%	3.8%	0.3%	4.2%	5.2%	5.2%	5.6%	5.0%
Refined Demand	Kt	24,001	24,949	25,205	25,821	26,725	27,789	28,322	29,185	30,113	31,054	31,982
Change y/y	%	0.6%	3.9%	1.0%	2.4%	3.5%	4.0%	1.9%	3.0%	3.2%	3.1%	3.0%
Balance	Kt	49	14	-17	37	178	147	-161	-268	-293	-868	-1,399
Energy transition demand												
EV		417	703	998	1,252	1,469	1,752	1,935	2,162	2,318	2,484	2,673
Wind & Solar		1,355	1,370	1,477	2,263	2,499	2,902	2,837	2,878	2,935	3,011	3,080
Electrical Infra		7,439	7,692	7,977	8,157	8,487	9,080	9,662	10,223	10,812	11,424	12,029
Total		9,211	9,765	10,452	11,671	12,455	13,734	14,434	15,263	16,065	16,919	17,782
Energy Transition %		31%	31%	33%	36%	37%	40%	41%	42%	43%	43%	44%
% of growth		331%	58%	268%	198%	87%	120%	131%	96%	87%	91%	93%

Source: UBS estimates

Figure 45: Aluminium Model


ALUMINIUM MODEL
 Global Commodities & Mining

Bauxite & Alumina		2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025e	2026e	2027e	2028e	2029e	2030e
Global Bauxite Supply	Mt	370	378	380	396	382	391	406	417	419	419	420
growth in supply	%	3.4%	2.0%	0.7%	4.1%	-3.5%	2.3%	3.8%	2.6%	1%	0%	0%
Global Bauxite Demand	Mt	370	378	380	396	382	393	406	418	421	423	423
Global Bauxite Balance	Mt						-2.3	0.1	-0.9	-2.3	-4	-3
Global Alumina Supply (Met grade)	Mt	124.9	130.1	132.1	134.3	136.9	144.2	148.8	153.0	154.5	154.9	155.0
growth in supply	%	1.8%	4.2%	1.5%	1.7%	1.9%	5.3%	3.2%	2.8%	0.9%	0%	0%
Global Alumina Demand	Mt	124.8	129.9	132.0	134.0	136.8	139.9	140.3	145.9	148.6	149.7	149.9
Alumina Market Balance	Mt	0.1	0.2	0.2	0.3	0.2	4.3	8.5	7.2	5.9	5.2	5.0
Aluminium												
Primary Smelter Supply												
China	Mt	37.0	38.5	40.1	41.8	43.3	44.6	45.5	45.5	45.5	45.5	45.5
Europe (ex Russia)	Mt	4.2	4.3	3.4	3.2	3.2	3.4	3.7	3.9	3.9	3.9	3.9
Russia	Mt	4.3	4.3	4.4	4.4	4.5	4.3	4.4	4.5	4.5	4.5	4.5
North America	Mt	4.1	4.1	3.9	4.1	4.0	4.0	4.0	4.1	4.1	4.1	4.1
Middle East	Mt	6.3	6.4	6.7	6.7	6.8	6.6	4.9	6.3	6.9	6.9	6.9
Other	Mt	9.1	9.8	10.2	10.6	10.8	11.3	11.9	13.1	14.0	14.6	14.7
Global Aluminium Supply	Mt	65.1	67.5	68.7	70.7	72.5	74.2	74.4	77.4	78.8	79.4	79.5
Growth	%	2.5%	3.7%	1.8%	2.9%	2.6%	2.3%	0.3%	3.9%	1.9%	0.8%	0.1%
Total Demand												
China	Mt	43.7	46.2	45.6	48.0	49.0	50.5	51.2	52.7	54.1	55.5	56.9
Europe	Mt	15.5	17.1	17.0	15.8	15.8	16.1	16.5	17.0	17.3	17.6	17.9
N America	Mt	9.4	10.3	10.7	10.7	10.8	10.9	11.3	11.8	12.1	12.5	12.9
Other	Mt	15.4	16.8	17.6	17.8	18.5	19.1	20.0	21.2	22.4	23.4	24.3
Total Demand	Mt	83.9	90.4	90.9	92.4	94.0	96.6	99.0	102.7	106.0	109.1	112.0
Growth	%	-3.5%	7.7%	0.5%	1.7%	1.7%	2.8%	2.4%	3.8%	3.2%	2.9%	2.7%
Secondary Demand	Mt	20.0	21.6	21.5	22.6	22.6	23.1	23.9	25.1	26.1	27.1	28.1
Growth	%	-5.9%	7.9%	-0.4%	5.0%	-0.1%	2.6%	3.4%	4.8%	4.2%	3.8%	3.5%
Primary demand												
China	Mt	37.5	39.4	39.8	40.8	42.1	43.4	43.9	45.2	46.3	47.4	48.4
Europe	Mt	9.9	11.1	11.0	10.3	10.2	10.5	10.7	11.0	11.2	11.3	11.5
N America	Mt	5.8	6.6	6.9	6.8	6.9	7.0	7.2	7.4	7.6	7.8	8.1
Other	Mt	10.7	11.6	11.7	11.8	12.3	12.7	13.2	14.0	14.7	15.4	15.9
Primary Demand	Mt	63.9	68.8	69.4	69.8	71.5	73.5	75.0	77.6	79.9	82.0	83.9
Growth	%	-2.8%	7.7%	0.8%	0.6%	2.4%	2.9%	2.1%	3.4%	2.9%	2.6%	2.4%
Aluminium Market Balance	Mt	1.16	-1.32	-0.66	0.87	1.06	0.68	-0.62	-0.26	-1.07	-2.56	-4.44
Year End Stock	Mt	12.0	10.7	10.0	10.9	11.9	12.6	12.0	11.7	10.7	8.1	3.7
Days Consumption	days	68	57	53	57	61	63	58	55	49	36	16
LME Aluminium Price	US\$/t	1,704	2,476	2,697	2,255	2,421	2,596	2,871	3,272	3,204	2,844	2,820
Alumina price average	US\$/t	270	329	362	344	500	390	338	375	400	400	423

Source: WoodMac, UBS estimates

Figure 46: Lithium Model

		2022A	2023A	2024A	2025A	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	2031E
Automotive Demand											
EV Sales (BEV + PHEV)	m units	10.5	14.2	17.7	20.7	24.0	29.3	33.7	39.1	46.1	51.2
%yly	%	55%	35%	25%	17%	16%	22%	15%	16%	18%	11%
Total Car Sales	m units	79.0	86.7	88.7	91.7	93.6	96.9	99.9	102.4	104.8	106.5
%yly	%	-2%	10%	2%	3%	2%	3%	3%	2%	2%	2%
% EV of New Car Sales	%	13%	16%	20%	23%	26%	30%	34%	38%	44%	48%
Li-ion Battery Demand											
Automotive Li-ion battery demand	GWh	489	693	844	1,012	1,174	1,433	1,647	1,911	2,255	2,503
Other motive demand	GWh	76	83	102	130	151	184	212	245	290	321
Total auto demand growth - %yly	%	54%	37%	22%	21%	16%	22%	15%	16%	18%	
ESS Li-ion battery demand	GWh	51	105	198	334	529	787	1,020	1,277	1,593	1,784
Total ESS demand growth - %yly	%	65%	107%	88%	69%	59%	49%	30%	25%	25%	
Total Li-ion battery demand	GWh	616	881	1,144	1,476	1,854	2,403	2,879	3,433	4,138	4,608
%yly	%	55%	43%	30%	29%	26%	30%	20%	19%	21%	11%
Lithium Demand by Use											
Automotive	kt LCE	461	605	707	908	975	1,133	1,293	1,496	1,661	1,775
ESS	kt LCE	46	85	212	293	491	613	753	895	991	1,144
Other Li-ion Demand	kt LCE	87	95	105	116	132	150	170	193	219	249
Non-Battery Demand	kt LCE	186	205	230	261	284	308	335	363	395	429
Change in Inventories	kt LCE	83	94	99	123	130	130	139	155	149	135
Total Lithium demand	kt LCE	863	1,083	1,354	1,702	2,012	2,335	2,690	3,104	3,416	3,731
%yly	%	48%	25%	25%	26%	18%	16%	15%	15%	10%	9%
Annual incremental demand	kt LCE	281	220	271	347	310	323	355	414	312	316
Risk Weighted Supply											
Operating	kt LCE	774	1,062	1,357	1,624	1,844	2,203	2,370	2,606	2,802	2,863
Base case	kt LCE	-	-	-	-	-	25	83	145	173	183
Probable	kt LCE	-	-	-	-	-	4	36	54	72	81
Possible	kt LCE	-	-	-	-	-	0	54	101	148	232
Hypothetical	kt LCE	-	-	-	-	-	-	8	14	31	100
Risk Weighted Supply	kt LCE	774	1,062	1,357	1,624	1,844	2,232	2,550	2,920	3,226	3,460
%yly	%	37%	37%	28%	20%	14%	21%	14%	14%	11%	7%
Annual incremental supply	kt LCE	209	288	296	267	220	388	318	370	307	233
Recycled Lithium											
% of battery demand	%	5.4%	5.4%	5.8%	5.4%	5.3%	5.3%	5.4%	6.1%	6.5%	7.0%
Market Balance											
change (-ve = tighter market)	kt chg	(57)	78	42	(68)	(77)	82	(19)	(7)	26	(48)
Market balance in weeks of consumption	weeks	(3.5)	1.0	2.4	(0.2)	(2.2)	(0.0)	(0.4)	(0.5)	(0.0)	(0.7)
Lithium Prices											
Lithium Carbonate - CIF China, Japan & Korea	US\$/mt	70,054	40,690	12,466	9,472	30,519	41,875	34,000	27,000	21,625	20,555
Lithium Hydroxide - CIF China, Japan & Korea	US\$/mt	72,405	44,705	12,037	9,239	30,314	41,875	34,000	27,000	21,625	20,555
Lithium Concentrate - 6% Li ₂ O - CFR China	US\$/mt	5,930	3,496	918	866	3,148	4,250	3,250	2,375	1,813	1,750

Source: WoodMac, UBS estimates

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